

Nicholas A. Huron, PhD

Senior Data Scientist • Predictive Modeling & Machine Learning • Statistical Analytics • R / Python / SQL
Asheville, NC • (484) 554-1530 • nahuron@gmail.com • [linkedin.com/in/nahuron](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nahuron) • github.com/nahuron

Professional Summary

Senior Data Scientist with a Ph.D. in Biology and 4+ years building production predictive models, statistical analyses, and reproducible analytics pipelines that turn large, messy relational datasets into measurable business decisions. Advanced R developer — including published R package authorship — with working Python and SQL, skilled in machine learning, feature engineering, time-series and rare-event modeling, and model validation. Equally comfortable validating raw database exports and presenting model-driven strategy to non-technical executives. Published, grant-winning researcher recognized for predictive modeling that quantified real-world economic impact.

Core Skills

Data Science & ML: predictive modeling, machine learning, statistical inference, ensemble methods, feature engineering, model validation, time-series analysis, historical trend analysis, rare-event / nonrandom-extinction modeling, reproducible research, data visualization, stakeholder communication

Programming: R (advanced, package & function development, R Markdown report writing, Tidyverse), Python, SQL, Bash / command line

Data Engineering & Analytics: relational database querying, ETL workflows, data cleaning, validation & sanitization, reproducible pipeline development, client-ready reporting

Geospatial & Specialized: GIS (ArcGIS, QGIS), spatial data analysis, ecological niche modeling (MaxEnt), species distribution modeling

Tools & Design: Git / GitHub version control, Adobe Illustrator / InDesign / Photoshop

Professional Experience

2022– **Senior Data Scientist** | Data Analytics | CCS Fundraising

- Design and deliver bespoke predictive models and historical trend analyses across client donor databases, surfacing high-value major and planned gift opportunities that directly inform multi-million-dollar campaign strategy across 100+ client engagements
- Architect end-to-end analytical pipelines in R: requesting, sanitizing, and validating relational database exports, then producing client-ready reports for full reproducibility
- Translate complex statistical models into clear, actionable strategy for non-technical nonprofit leaders through executive-level presentations
- Lead migration of core analytics products from legacy GUI-based tools to a reproducible R ecosystem, standardizing outputs and reducing human error
- Coauthor white papers & present on nonprofit fundraising at industry conferences

2017–2022 **Graduate Researcher**, Integrative Ecology Lab, Temple University

- *Dissertation:* “Building frameworks for understanding invasions and extinctions for biodiversity science”
- Co-wrote and won a \$76,890 USDA grant; built ensemble species distribution models forecasting spotted lanternfly establishment and agricultural impact across the US
- First-authored a publication in Communications Biology (Nature portfolio) quantifying a pest’s potential to disrupt the global wine market — an applied, large-scale predictive-modeling result
- Contributed to ENMTools 1.0, an open-source R package for comparative ecological biogeography (Ecography, 2021), demonstrating collaborative software development

- 2014–2017 **Research Assistant**, Cameron Siler Lab, University of Oklahoma
- Led international fieldwork surveying Philippine herpetofauna; co-authored peer-reviewed species-discovery publications
 - Led fieldwork on an Oklahoma Department of Wildlife Conservation grant: collaborated on survey protocols, organized field teams, and supported reporting on species distribution and disease status
- 2009–2014 **Research Assistant**, Honeycutt and Kats Labs, Pepperdine University
- Applied molecular phylogeographic techniques to analyze populations of *Taricha torosa*; organized and led multi-year stream surveys for USGS and California State Parks
 - Authored research proposals, reviewed manuscripts, and presented findings at departmental and regional meetings
- 2013–2020 **Additional Experience**: Teaching/Applied Biology, Temple U; U of OK; Mountains Restoration Trust
- Graduate Teaching Assistant across Introductory Biology, Principles of Ecology, and Field Herpetology; mentored undergraduate researchers
 - Curatorial Assistant for Herpetology and Mammalogy Collections: conducted taxonomic revision, specimen acquisition and processing, and digitization of collection records
 - Restoration Ecologist: co-led an invasive crayfish (*Procambarus clarkii*) removal project: supervised trapping, data collection, and public education

Education

- 2022 Ph.D. Biology, Temple University
- 2013 B.S. Biology (Magna Cum Laude), Pepperdine University

Selected Research Impact

Funding & Awards: \$76,890 U.S. Dept. of Agriculture predictive-modeling grant (2019, co-authored); ASIH Stoye Award in Conservation (2018); SSAR Henri C. Seibert Award in Ecology (2015)

Publications: 13 publications/preprints across Communications Biology, Ecography, Oikos (in press), Proceedings of the California Academy of Sciences, Herpetological Review, and bioRxiv

Presentations: Apra Prospect Development (2023, 2024, 2026); APRA Data Science Now (2024); Ecological Society of America; Joint Meetings of Ichthyologists & Herpetologists

Selected Publications

- Huron, NA, Hedges, SB, Helmus, MR. 2022. Detecting stabilizing, directional, and disruptive patterns of anthropogenic species loss with general models of nonrandom extinction. bioRxiv. doi:10.1101/2022.09.11.507476.
- Huron, NA, Behm, JE, Helmus, MR. 2022. Paninvasion severity assessment of a U.S. grape pest to disrupt the global wine market. Communications Biology, 5:1–11. doi:10.1038/s42003-022-03580-w.
- Warren, DL, ... Huron, NA, et al. 2021. ENMTools 1.0: an R package for comparative ecological biogeography. Ecography. doi:10.1111/ecog.05485.
- Diesmos, AC, ... Huron, NA, et al. 2015. Amphibians of the Philippines, part I: checklist of the species. Proceedings of the California Academy of Sciences, 62:457–539. Google Scholar.

Comprehensive curriculum vitae, full publication list, code portfolio, and references available upon request.